

## Chapter 2

# Planning for innovation

Every organization needs to innovate to keep pace with a changing world. But unless you know where, what, and why you want to change, your blueprint for innovation will come to nothing. Careful planning is essential for successful innovation.

## Innovating strategically

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Developing a roadmap for change, or an innovation strategy, can help your organization stay ahead of the competition over the long term. Any innovation project involves resources—money, time, employees' skills—and you need to spend these wisely if an innovation is to be worthwhile.



### TIP

#### BACK UP YOUR DECISIONS

Make sure all your decisions have sound strategic backing in line with the wide aims of the organization.

### Developing a strategy

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An innovation strategy requires three key elements:

- **Strategic analysis:** what *could* you do, and why would that make a difference?
- **Strategic decision-making:** what *are* you going to do, and why are you choosing that option over others?
- **Strategic action:** how can you make sure the project happens, and support and review it as the innovation takes shape? Some of the most important innovation decisions are not about starting projects, but scrapping those which looked good at the outset but which then failed to develop as expected.